THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 7 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 5: **Cities and States: The Second Urbanisation** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. A historian finds iron tools and punch-marked coins in a layer of a town. This suggests 1

(a) Gupta rule
(b) Mughal settlement
(c) agricultural growth and trade in the Second Urbanisation
(d) Harappan settlement

2. If a city lies at the meeting of rivers, its likely advantage is 1

(a) no trade **(b)** no people
(c) desert climate **(d)** transport and fertile land

3. Two mahajanapadas both control iron mines. The more likely outcome is 1

(a) rivalry to control routes and resources **(b)** peace without rivalry
(c) no trade **(d)** no war

4. An assembly chooses the head of state in an early republic. This shows 1

(a) foreign rule **(b)** colonial rule
(c) collective decision making **(d)** hereditary rule

5. Which of these is a reason for the rise of new religions in this period? 1

(a) questioning of rituals and social change **(b)** no change
(c) no cities **(d)** no trade

6. Which fact weakens the claim that early republics were fully democratic? 1

(a) women ruled
(b) all adults voted
(c) no assembly
(d) participation was limited to a certain group

7. Which clue best indicates a city's role as a trade centre? 1

(a) no walls **(b)** many coins and goods from distant places
(c) farm tools only **(d)** large forests

8. Which is a likely effect of coinage on tax systems? 1

(a) easier assessment and collection **(b)** more barter
(c) no records **(d)** no taxes

9. **Assertion (A):** Mahajanapadas were larger states formed by joining janapadas. 1
Reason (R): Magadha was one of the most powerful mahajanapadas.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** Vajji and Malla were republic mahajanapadas. 1
Reason (R): In republics, rule was by assemblies rather than a single king.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How did coins affect taxation? 2

12. How did trade routes create cities? 2

13. Why is the term 'urbanisation' used for this period? 2

14. Why is archaeology needed in addition to texts? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Evaluate the importance of iron in state formation. 3

16. Analyse the effects of surplus on society. 3

17. Analyse why Taxila and Pataliputra were important in different ways. 3

OR

Analyse why the republican system declined. 3

18. Examine how rivers shaped the location of capitals. 3

OR

Compare life in villages and cities in the period. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** Around the sixth century BCE, Rajagriha was a busy capital in the Ganga plain. A strong wall with narrow gateways surrounded it, and traders used silver punch-marked coins in its markets. Officers collected taxes to support the army and the ruler. 5
(i) Of which mahajanapada was Rajagriha an early capital?
(ii) What were the early coins called?
(iii) Why were gateways kept narrow?
(iv) How did taxes help the rulers of these states?

20. Evaluate the nature of governance in monarchies and republics in the sixteen mahajanapadas. 5

OR

Discuss the importance of trade routes, markets and guilds in sustaining cities. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks